San Francisco Ramp Tower
Standard Operating Procedure
Version 1.0

List of Changes

VERSION	DATE	DESCRIPTION
1.0	04SEP2025	Initial release

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Section 1. General Information

1-1 Purpose

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) outlines the procedures to be used by controllers working San Francisco Ramp Tower positions on the VATSIM network, to ensure that traffic flows are handled in as efficient and timely a manner as possible. This SOP is for simulation purposes only and shall not be used for real world use or reference.

1-2 Distribution

This SOP is distributed to all members of the Oakland ARTCC on VATSIM and members of Virtual Airline organizations with whom the Oakland ARTCC on VATSIM has an LOA.

1-3 Cancellation

Reserved.

1-4 Positions Table

The following position table details authorized positions for San Francisco Ramp.

POSITION	RADIO CALLSIGN	FREQUENCY
A Gates Ramp	Ramp Tower	127.575
G Gates Ramp	Ramp Tower	119.225
United Ramp	United Tower	131.000

When the Ramp Tower positions are combined, the A Ramp Tower position is used.

1-5 Jurisdiction

a. A-Gates Ramp Tower is responsible for the following gates/parking, taxilanes, and locations:
    a. Gates A1-A15, B1-B5, B10-B11S, B15-B16S, B19-B20, B23V-B27
    NOTE- *Gate B23 is controlled by SFO ATCT*
    b. Plot 2 / Remain Overnight (RON) Parking
    c. Taxilanes M1, M2, M3, M4, M5; Spots 1, 2, 3, 4
b. G-Gates Ramp Tower is responsible for the following gates/parking locations:
    a. Gates F1-F4, F12, F14, F16-F19, G1-G14T, G103-G105
    b. Plot 6, Plot 9
    c. Taxilanes B, B5, North Line (Spot 8 line), South Line (Spot 9 line); Spots 8, 9, 10, 11
c. UAL Ramp Tower is responsible for the following gates:
    a. Gates E1-E3, E6, E8, E10U, E10V, F5-F8
    b. Spots 7A, 7, 7B

1-6 Phraseology

a. When authorizing an aircraft to pushback, specify a taxilane/line to push onto, if applicable:

   PHRASEOLOGY-
   <CALLSIGN>, PUSHBACK APPROVED
   (if applicable) ONTO <TAXILANE/LINE>

   NOTE- *Specifying a taxilane is not required if there is only one taxilane available*

b. Issue the route for an outbound aircraft to follow using taxilane/line and spot identifiers:

   PHRASEOLOGY-
   <CALLSIGN>, PROCEED TO <SPOT> VIA <ROUTE> AND CONTACT GROUND

c. Issue the spot to enter at and route to follow for inbound aircraft waiting to enter the non-movement area:

   PHRASEOLOGY-
   <CALLSIGN>, ENTER AT <SPOT>, PROCEED TO <GATE> VIA <ROUTE>
   or
   <CALLSIGN>, GATE <GATE>, PROCEED VIA <SPOT> <ROUTE>

d. If necessary, issue an instruction for aircraft to transition between taxilanes/lines:

   PHRASEOLOGY-
   <CALLSIGN>, TRANSITION ONTO <TAXILANE>

e. When authorizing simultaneous pushback operations on parallel taxilanes/lines, issue the relevant traffic:

   PHRASEOLOGY-
   REFERENCE THE TRAFFIC ON THE <TAXILANE> LINE

f. Inform aircraft when their gate is occupied and they are required to hold at a separate location:

   PHRASEOLOGY-
   <CALLSIGN>, YOUR GATE IS STILL OCCUPIED, PROCEED TO <LOCATION> AND HOLD (if required) <DIRECTION TO FACE>

1-7 Gate Assignment Procedures

a. Gate assignment procedures will be activated with the concurrence of an event CIC (as defined in CPS-004) and in coordination with the SFO ATCT.
b. Ramp Control shall be responsible for assigning gates to all inbound aircraft, including those parking at gates where pushback is controlled by SFO ATCT.
c. When multiple ramp control positions are staffed, the responsibility for making all gate assignments will be delegated to a single position.
d. Ramp Control shall make gate assignments to inbound aircraft approximately when they cross a 30 nm range ring centered at SFO.
e. Upon making a gate assignment, Ramp Control will private message the aircraft the assignment.
f. As needed, Ramp Control shall provide gate assignments to SFO ATCT.

Section 2. A Gates Ramp

2-1 Gate Usage and Restrictions

a. Parking positions A4T, A7T, and B1 at the corresponding gates are not used or no longer exist, despite still being charted.

b. The following table outlines usage of multi-purpose gates/stands with multiple parking positions, and usage restrictions in conjunction with neighboring gates/stands:

GATE/STAND	POSITION	POSITIONS BLOCKED
A1	A1T	A1V
	A1V	A1T
A13	A13R	A13V
	A13V	A13R, A14T
B5	B5	B5S
	B5S	B5, B4
B11	B11	B11S
	B11S	B10, B11
B16	B16	B16S
	B16S	B15, B16
B20	B20 (right line)	B20 (left line)
	B20 (left line)	B19, B20 (right line)
B23	B23	B23V
	B23V	B23, B24
B27	B27	B27V
	B27V	B26, B27

c. All parking positions can accommodate ADG-III aircraft except as noted in the table below:

POSITION	MAX SIZE	POSITION	MAX SIZE
A1V	ADG-V	A12	ADG-V up to 200 ft
A2	ADG-V	A13V	ADG-V
A5	ADG-V	B5S	ADG-VI
A6	ADG-VI	B11S	ADG-VI
A8	ADG-V	B16S	ADV-VI
A9	ADG-V	B20 (left)	ADG-VI
A10	ADG-V	B23V	ADG-V
A11	ADG-VI	B27V	ADG-V

d. Whenever an A388 is parked at gate A6, no B77L/B77W or A359/A35K can park at gate A2.

2-2 Taxilane Restrictions

a. Taxilanes M2 and M5 are restricted to ADG-V aircraft or smaller.
b. Taxilane M3 is restricted to ADG-III aircraft or smaller.
c. ADG-VI aircraft must use taxilanes M1 and M4, and enter/exit at Spot 1.
d. ADG-IV and ADG-V inbound aircraft parking at B27 must use Spot 2 and taxilane M2.
e. When an aircraft is on taxilane M4, taxilanes M3 and M5 are not usable.

2-3 Pushback Procedures

a. Simultaneous pushback operations on the M3 and M5 taxilanes are authorized. Aircraft must be informed of simultaneous pushback traffic.
b. Aircraft parked at gates A1, A2, A6, A7, A8, A11, and A13R push back onto taxilane M5.
    i. Aircraft parked at A13R may also push back onto taxilane M2.
    ii. ADG-VI aircraft must push back onto taxilane M4.
c. Aircraft parked at gates A4, A5, A9, A10, A12, A14, and A15 and Plot 2 push back onto taxilane M2, but the taxilane need not be included in the push back instructions.
d. Aircraft parked at gates B2, B4, B5, B10, B11, B15, B16, B19, B20, and B27 push back onto taxilane M3.
    i. ADG-IV or larger aircraft must push back onto taxilane M4.
e. Aircraft parked at gates B23V, B24, B25, and B26 push back onto taxilane M1.

2-4 Inbound/Outbound Procedures

a. Spot 1 is utilized for inbound aircraft and Spot 2 is utilized for outbound aircraft, except where required based on aircraft dimensions or as coordinated.
    i. Ramp may coordinate with SFO ATCT to utilize Spot 2 as the entry point and Spot 1 as the exit point.
b. Spot 3 and Spot 4 are used as holding points.
c. Traffic from gates B23V, B24, B25, and B26 that was pushed back onto taxilane M1 is transitioned onto taxilane M2 and is transferred to SFO ATCT at Spot 2.
    i. Ramp may coordinate with SFO ATCT to have these aircraft exit at Spot 1.

Section 3. G Gates Ramp

3-1 Gate Usage and Restrictions

a. Gates F1-F4 are under construction, with expected completion in Fall 2027.
b. The following table outlines usage of multi-purpose gates/stands with multiple parking positions, and usage restrictions in conjunction with neighboring gates/stands:

GATE/STAND	POSITION	POSITIONS BLOCKED
G12	G12T	G12V, G12S
	G12V	G11R, G12T, G12S
	G12S	G11R, G12T, G12V
G13	G13R	G13S
	G13S	G13R, G14T

c. All parking positions can accommodate ADG-III aircraft except as noted in the table below:

POSITION	MAX SIZE	POSITION	MAX SIZE
F12	ADG-IV up to 140 ft	G5	ADG-V
F14	ADG-IV	G6	ADG-V
F16	ADG-IV up to 125 ft	G7	ADG-V
F17	ADG-V up to 200 ft	G8	ADG-V
F18	ADG-II	G9	ADG-V
F19	ADG-V	G10	ADG-V
G1	ADG-V	G12V	ADG-V
G2	ADG-V	G12S	ADG-VI
G3	ADG-V	G13S	ADG-VI
G4	ADG-V		

d. Whenever an ADG-V aircraft is parked at gate F17, gate F16 is only usable for ADG-III aircraft.
e. Whenever an ADG-IV or larger aircraft is parked at gate F17, gate F18 is unusable.
f. B773, B77W, and A35K aircraft cannot use gates G1, G3, or G4.
g. A359 aircraft cannot use gates G1 or G3.

3-2 Taxilane Restrictions

a. ADG-VI aircraft must use the Spot 10 line to enter and exit the ramp.

3-3 Pushback Procedures

a. Aircraft parked at gates F3A, F4, F12, F14, F16, F17, F18, and F19 push back onto the North line.
b. Aircraft parked at gates F1, F2, F3, G1, G2, G5, G6, G9, G10, and G14T push back onto the South line.
c. Aircraft parked at gates G3, G4, G7, G8, G11, G12, and G13 and the remote parking stands G103, G104, and G105 push back onto taxilane B, but the taxilane need not be included in the push back instructions.

3-4 Inbound/Outbound Procedures

a. Spot 10 is utilized for outbound aircraft and Spot 11 is utilized for inbound aircraft, except where required based on aircraft dimensions or as coordinated.
b. Inbound traffic to Spot 8 and Spot 9 enters the ramp at Spot 11 and is routed via taxilane B5 as needed.
c. Outbound traffic from Spot 8 and Spot 9 shall be instructed to contact SFO ATCT once they reach the marked spots.
d. Traffic from gates F1, F2, F3, F3A, and F4 will be facing east on the North/South lines, and can be instructed either to remain on the same line after performing a 180 turn, or to transition to the opposite side line.
e. ADG-III or smaller aircraft may be instructed to proceed to and hold at 11-1, 11-2, or 11-3 if their gate is unavailable.

Section 4. United Ramp

4-1 Gate Usage and Restrictions

a. The following table outlines usage of multi-purpose gates/stands with multiple parking positions, and usage restrictions in conjunction with neighboring gates/stands:

GATE/STAND	POSITION	POSITIONS BLOCKED
E3	E3T	E3K
	E3K	E2, E3T
E10	E10U	E10V
	E10V	E8, E10U

b. All parking positions can accommodate ADG-III aircraft except as noted in the table below:

POSITION	MAX SIZE	POSITION	MAX SIZE
E3K	ADG-IV up to 145 ft	F7	ADG-III up to 95 ft
E10V	ADG-V	F8	ADG-III up to 95 ft
F6	ADG-III up to 95 ft		

4-2 Spot Restrictions

a. Spots 7A and 7B are restricted to ADG-III, or ADG-IV up to a wingspan of 145 ft, or smaller.
b. Spots 7A and 7B are not usable when Spot 7 is in use.

4-3 Pushback Procedures

a. Aircraft parked at gates E2, E3, E6, F6, F7, and F8 push back onto the Spot 7A line.
b. Aircraft parked at gates E1, E8, E10, and F5 push back onto the Spot 7B line.
c. ADG-V aircraft parked at position E10V are instructed to push back onto the Spot 7 line, tail north and contact SFO ATCT. SFO ATCT will approve a continuation of the push onto taxiway A.

4-4 Inbound/Outbound Procedures

a. Outbound aircraft are instructed to contact SFO ATCT once they have completed their push back and pulled up to the assigned spot.
b. Inbound aircraft parking at gates E1, F5, F6, F7, and F8 enter the ramp via the Spot 7A line.
c. Inbound aircraft parking at gates E2, E3, E6, E8, and E10 enter the ramp via the Spot 7B line, except for ADG-IV or larger aircraft parking at position E10V.

Appendix 1. Aircraft Design Groups

ADG	WINGSPAN	TAIL HEIGHT	EXAMPLE TYPES
I	<49 ft	<20 ft	C421, PA31
II	49 to <79 ft	20 to <30 ft	CRJ2, CRJ7, E145
III	79 to <118 ft	30 to <45 ft	A320, B738, CRJ9, DH8D, E75L
IV	118 to <171 ft	45 to <60 ft	A310, B752, B764, MD11
V	171 to <214 ft	60 to <66 ft	A332, A35K, B744, B772
VI	214 to <262 ft	66 to <80 ft	A388, B748